Longshim Youth Dormitory System

Resource Identifier: CULT-CUST-001

English Translation: Traditional Youth Dormitory Institution

Category: Custom | Subcategory: Social_Institution

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Ancestral Village Community (Documented in Hodson 1911, Ruivah 1993)

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Continuous traditional educational institution

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Central indigenous institution divided into Mayarshim (boys dormitory) and Ngashim (girls dormitory). Functioned as educational center for transmitting oral songs, customary discipline, weaving, and woodcraft.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Longshim wui ngashan kasak iramli thot kachung pamhai."
"Mayarshimli ralong ngasoda ngashun themthot tamching."
"Ngashimli kashan kasa, sam kapa, chanjam tui shashap."

English Translation & Meaning:

"The Longshim dormitory system has stood for generations as the educational pillar of our village."
"In the Mayarshim, young men master warfare, woodcraft, ethics, and oral histories."
"In the Ngashim, young women master loom weaving, basketry, folk songs, and customary etiquette."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Admission of adolescent youths into the respective gender dormitory (Mayarshim or Ngashim).
2. Nightly residence under the guidance of senior mentors and clan elders.
3. Training in oral folklore, weaving, agriculture, customary law, and community discipline.
4. Collective mobilization for village public works, path clearing, and harvest assistance.
5. Graduation upon marriage and transition into household adulthood.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Adolescent Youths, Dormitory Guardians, Senior Clan Mentors